



sion lines, roads, sewerage, drinking water, desalination, and irrigation are vastly different,” Reddy says.

The Thane-Borivali tunnel project (involving the construction of two road tunnels of 10.8 km each) was a significant win. Megha beat L&T’s bid. L&T went to court but lost. The road tunnel will cut travel time between Thane and Borivali from an hour today to 15 minutes. “It will be ready in less than four years. Even in Zoji-la, there were five or six bidders (L&T and Ircon were the prominent names), and MEIL won it,” he declares. He repeatedly stresses on MEIL’s professionalism and cites the Bandra Kurla Complex station project win as an example. “You will not win projects otherwise,” he says.

Getting the pricing right is MEIL’s strong point. And it claims to do so without cutting corners on technology or quality of work. (Clue: it is not crazy about fat margins.) Take the case of Mongolia,

MEGHA’S MEDIA NET

Megha’s P.V. Krishna Reddy made an interesting strategic investment in media brand TV9 in 2018 together with the promoters of the My Home group

BY **KRISHNA GOPALAN**

IN HYDERABAD’S BANJARA Hills, a tony location in the city, sits the large TV9 headquarters. The building displays a prominent logo of TV9, which has made a mark for itself in the Telugu news business. Under the umbrella of Associated Broadcasting Company Private Limited (ABCPL), TV9 got off the ground in 2004 with a 24-hour Telugu TV news channel. Since then, it has expanded its presence to four more regional markets—Kannada,

crore with a net profit of ₹53 crore. A credit rating report put out by ICRA last March points out that ABCPL is promoted by Alanda Media & Entertainment Private Limited, “which is ultimately held by promoters from Hyderabad-based My Home Constructions Private Limited and Megha Engineering & Infrastructures Limited”. The deal to acquire ABCPL from serial entrepreneur Srinivasa Raju, Co-founder and Chairman of iLabs Venture Capital Fund, former COO of Satyam Computer

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TV9 WAS ACQUIRED JUST BEFORE THE GENERAL ELECTIONS OF 2019

Marathi, Gujarati, and Bangla—and Hindi, with TV9 Bharatvarsh. It entered the digital space, with websites and YouTube channels, around three years ago.

Let’s take a look at its financial performance. The company had revenues of ₹633 crore in FY23 with a net loss of ₹7.8 crore; in FY22, it had posted revenues of ₹545

Services and founding CEO of Cognizant India, was struck in mid-2018 for ₹450 crore. Raju and his staff together held a little over 90%, while the rest was with V. Ravi Prakash, the channel’s founding CEO. Alanda Media was the special-purpose vehicle created for the deal.

Speaking to *Business Today*, P.V. Krishna Reddy, Managing Director of